

BioEdit Institutional Biosafety Committee Meeting Minutes

Date: Thursday, March 12, 2026

Time: 10:30 am – 11:30 am EST

Virtual

IBC Member Attendance:

Name	Member Role/Expertise	Present/Absent
E. Helmes	Chair	Present
R. Van Dorn	Secretary/Contact	Present
D. Gangaiah	Recombinant/synthetic nucleic acid molecules; infectious disease	Present
D. Susanti	Microbiology	Present
S. Manuja	Animal Containment	Present
A. Wells	Non-Affiliated Community	Present
S. Mowery	Non-Affiliated Community	Present

Quorum met.

Non-IBC Members in Attendance: R. Kumar, T. Burtchett

The meeting was called to order at 7:34 am PST/10:34 am EST

1. Conflict of interest Disclosure: S. Mowery has a conflict of interest on project BE-105. D. Gangaiah has a conflict of interest for projects BE-105 and BE-106. D. Susanti has a conflict of interest for project BE117A/BE117B. IBC Members with conflict of interests will abstain from voting on the specific project that they have disclosed.
2. IBC Project Forms
 - a. BE-106 Clinical: Microbially vectored DNA vaccine for the protection of broiler chickens from *Eimeria* sp. Infection.
 - i. Project Summary: Coccidiosis in chickens is characterized by damaged gut lining, poor nutrient absorption, reduced weight and sometimes death. The causative agent of coccidiosis is a group of apicomplexan parasites in the *Eimeria* genus that spread to other chickens through the production and shedding of oocysts. Current vaccines include oocysts to generate an immune response; however, their production is expensive and labor intensive. Further, the economic burden of coccidiosis on the poultry industry is increasing, highlighting the need for alternative preventative measures for the control of coccidiosis. This project aims to develop a vaccine [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
In vivo assessment of vaccine candidate efficacy and other animal studies will be carried out at a contract research organization.

Applicable NIH Guidelines Section: III-D

- ii. Risk Assessment Discussion: The IBC discussed the mode of action.

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] It was also discussed that a 103.3 permit would be obtained from USDA CVB before the investigational material was shipped to the contract research organization.

- iii. Training: Training has been verified

- iv. Containment Level: BSL 1/BL1-N

- v. Motion: E. Helmes moved to approve the Project as presented. A. Wells seconded. Motion passed with one abstention (D. Gangaiah).

- b. BE-105 (*in vivo*): Microbially vectored peptide therapeutic for obesity and Type 2 diabetes in cats and dogs

- i. Project Summary: Obesity is a common disease of cats with high prevalence and poses significant health risks. The goal of the current project is to develop an oral therapeutic for treating obesity in cats

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] The project will involve testing efficacy of [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

- ii. Applicable NIH Guidelines Section: III-D

- iii. Risk Assessment Discussion: The animals used in the study are laboratory animals and are not client-owned.

- iv. Training: Training has been verified

- v. Containment Level: BSL 1

- vi. Motion: R. Van Dorn moved to approve the Project as presented. A. Wells seconded. Motion passed with two abstentions (D. Gangaiah and S. Mowery).

- c. BE117A and BE117B (*in vivo*): Clearance and Persistence of a [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] in Lactating Dairy Cows

- i. Project Summary: The study is being carried out at a university that has its own IBC to test the spread of engineered variants [REDACTED] in cows. The cows will be administered the engineered [REDACTED]. The IBC at the university has approved the study with BL1-N containment; the approval form was provided to the BiomEdit IBC.
- ii. Applicable NIH Guidelines Section: III-D
- iii. Risk Assessment Discussion: The IBC had no discussion topics regarding the risk assessment for the project.
- iv. Training: Training has been verified
- v. Containment Level: BL1-N
- vi. Motion: E. Helmes moved to approve the Project as presented. S. Mowery seconded. Motion passed with one abstention (D. Sustanti).

3. Discussion Topics

a. Approval Forms

- i. R. Van Dorn raised the topic of IBC approval form structure (signature, voting record, etc). The committee decided that the approval form structure could be changed. If a change is implemented, the Policy and Procedure should be reviewed to determine if any updates are required.

b. Timing of next IBC meeting

- i. The next IBC meeting will be scheduled for the first two weeks of May. R. Van Dorn will send out a request for IBC member availability.

The meeting was adjourned at 8:22 am PST/11:22 am EST.